Lakshman Thota

(480) 869-5699 | lakshmant006@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/lakshman-thota/ | lakzh7.art/craft

SUMMARY

UX designer and researcher with experience translating architectural, operational, and customer needs into intuitive digital experiences. Combines contextual inquiry, user journey mapping, interactive prototyping, **design thinking**, and **systems thinking** to simplify complex workflows and improve collaboration between stakeholders.

EDUCATION

Arizona State University, Tempe, AZ | Master of Science, User Experience | Aug 2024 – May 2026

BMS School of Architecture, Bangalore, India | Bachelor of Architecture | Apr 2019 – Apr 2024

SKILLS

UX Research: User interviews, contextual inquiry, mixed-methods research, usability testing, personas, journey mapping, thematic analysis

Product Design: Design thinking, systems thinking, wireframing, prototyping, interaction design, information architecture, accessibility, design systems

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Adobe Creative Cloud, Autodesk Forma, SketchUp, Excel, AI-assisted prototyping

Collaboration: Stakeholder interviews, requirements gathering, cross-functional communication, workshop facilitation, research presentations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Arcadia Custom Builders | UX Researcher | Jun 2025 – Present

- Developed interactive prototypes, wireframes, and user flows to communicate design alternatives, clarify complex project requirements, and support more informed client approval decisions.
- Synthesized contextual inquiry and stakeholder feedback into research-backed personas and end-to-end journey maps, connecting user pain points with actionable design revisions.
- Collaborated with clients and multidisciplinary teams through recurring design reviews, surfacing workflow bottlenecks and design conflicts earlier in the project lifecycle.

23DDS | Architectural Intern | Feb 2024 – Jul 2024

- Produced detailed 3D architectural models, CAD drawings, and construction documentation to support client presentations, technical reviews, and coordinated project delivery.
- Worked with architects and MEP consultants across multiple building disciplines to identify drawing inconsistencies, reconcile requirements, and reduce avoidable design handoff friction.
- Participated in site visits and construction observations, translating field conditions and practical build constraints into clearer drawings and documentation updates.

UBC Impex | Product Developer | Jul 2020 – Aug 2022

- Led design and development of a time-management application serving **50+ employees**, bringing clock-in, attendance tracking, and accountability workflows into one user-centered interface.
- Designed **2 core management capabilities**—skills tracking and role-based dashboards—to help managers review employee competencies, activity, and operational needs.
- Gathered requirements through manager and employee interviews, then iterated on interface flows and usability feedback to make everyday administrative tasks easier to complete.

SELECTED PROJECTS

KeepX × Meta AI | AI-powered memory journal

Designed a mobile product combining **3 memory formats**—photos, journal entries, and conversational recall—with interactive onboarding and personalized retrieval to make meaningful moments easier to revisit.

Procreate Motion-Rigging Extension | Animation prototype

Prototyped a 2D character animation workflow integrating **MediaPipe tracking, custom skeletal rigging, and spring dynamics**; explored smoother motion, deformation, and animator-friendly controls.

CERTIFICATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

CITI Program — Human Research (Feb 2023) | Published article: *AI in Architectural Studies* (Medium)